



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

(b) Elucidate the determinants of kinship terminology. (15 marks)

Kinship terminology is the nature of terms by which kinsmen call each other.

Determinants of kinship terminology

① Evolutionary perspective: L.H. Morgan explained that as a society evolves, kinship terminology evolves from classificatory terminology to descriptive terminology.

② Marriageability: Levi-Strauss gave the theory that kinship terms are decided by the marriageability. He says that the function of kinship itself is to decide the marital alliances.

E.g. In South India, cross cousins and parallel cousins are called by different terms as cross-cousin marriages are allowed.

③ Nature of society and family: In the societies where nuclear families take importance, the kinship revolves around the nuclear family.

Eg. In English kinship terminology, all cousins are called cousins irrespective of gender & relation. This is called Eskimo kinship terminology type.

~~④ Kinship type~~

④ Line of descent: The kinship terminology also depends on whether the society is a patrilineal or matrilineal descent.

Eg. Omaha system is used by patrilineal societies while Crow system is used by matrilineal societies.

⑤ Functionalist perspective: For functionalists like Malinowski, kinship terms are

mere algebraic terms unless there is some underlying function attached to them.

While kinship terminologies of evolutionary order as given by Morgan are no longer held valid, the factors like organisation of society, patrilineal & matrilineal descent, marriageability, economic nature of society form a key role in determining the kinship terminologies of a society.